Mujahideen leadership. Already angry at New Delhi's biased Afghanistan policy, Massoud threatened to review all bilateral agreements India had signed with the communists. Even on the Kashmir issue, as India's then ambassador in Kabul Nambiar put it, these Mujahideen factions 'kept their counsel' but were generally 'supportive of the Pakistani position'.[13] But this did not mean a breakdown of diplomatic ties. Adopting a conciliatory approach despite their disappointment, the Mujahideen were keen on developing a stable relationship with India, but on their own terms. Rao had surely rectified the errors of his predecessors on Afghanistan, but the Mujahideen would take a call on the nature and expanse of this relationship (such was the case, arguably, throughout the 1990s).

The Mujahideen's suspicion with India was not a one-way affair either. Even though Rao had penned a conciliatory approach and the Mujahideen had reciprocated, Massoud and Haq's disappointment offered fodder to some of India's partisans who challenged the conciliators. Underlining the fact that partisans and conciliators cut across party politics and bureaucratic lines, the then home minister Y B Chavan stated on 27 May 1992, that 'the possibility of the Afghan Mujahideen concentrating on the Jammu and Kashmir border now, with the help of the Pakistan army, to give a fresh impetus to militants in the valley cannot not be ruled out.'[14] Indian media reported that a 'Pak-Afghan nexus bodes ill for India.'[15] According to reports Najibullah's ouster was the closest Pakistan had 'ever been to realising its much publicised "strategic depth" military doctrine'. Three aspects that India needed to keep an eye out for, warned commentators, were (a) Massoud's request to Pakistan to restructure the Afghan militia, divided along ethnic lines, into a federal army; (b) Mojaddedi's swift invitation to Pakistan's officials for restoring civilian infrastructure; and (c) Pakistan's decision to 'dump' Hekmatyar in support of Massoud and elevate Rabbani as the next President after Mojaddedi. The *Times of India* criticised India's policy efforts as a 'lost opportunity' and for its rigidity on dealing only at the 'government level', whereas Pakistan grasped 'the ground situation and [backed] the winning side in time.'[16] This criticism stood vindicated as the Indian embassy in Kabul, among those of other countries, was shutdown due to vandalism by Mujahideen elements in June 1992. By July, about 1,800 Afghans who practiced Hinduism and Sikhism fled the country, 'unable to bear the treatment meted out by the